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GLOSSARY: Emotional Physics & System Architecture (Full Entry Update)

This glossary defines the core terms used in Emotional Physics, Trust-Center Mechanics, and System-Level Diagnostics. Each term is written in neutral, structural language suitable for organizational, legal, and cross-cultural environments.

1. Cognitive Gap

Definition:

The structural difference between two systems' ability to interpret emotional, relational, or organizational information. A cognitive gap appears when one system operates on **mechanics** (pressure, drift, trust, signal) and another operates on **narrative or pattern-matching**.

Why it matters:

Cognitive gaps explain why two people (or two systems) can look at the same situation and produce completely different interpretations. The gap is architectural, not emotional.

2. Emotional Logic (EL)

Definition:

The internal rule-set a person uses to interpret emotional information. Emotional Logic is not about feelings — it is about the *structure* behind how someone makes sense of emotional signals.

Two primary modes:

- **Narrative EL:** Emotion interpreted as story, identity, or interpersonal meaning.
- **Structural EL:** Emotion interpreted as pressure, drift, signal, or system behavior.

Why it matters:

People with different ELs don't just disagree — they literally see different worlds.

3. Emotional Physics

Definition:

A structural framework for understanding human behavior using **pressure, drift, trust density, signal, identity coherence, and field conditions**. Emotional Physics treats emotion as **data**, not narrative.

Key properties:

- invariant
 - multi-scale
 - predictive
 - pressure-responsive
 - system-referential
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4. Emotional Physics vs AI Pattern Engines

Definition:

A comparison between two fundamentally different cognitive architectures.

Emotional Physics:

- uses invariants
- reads pressure, drift, trust, signal
- predicts behavior from mechanics
- works across scales
- treats emotion as data

AI Pattern Engines:

- predict the next likely word
- use correlation, not causality
- track sentiment, not pressure
- cannot maintain stable models of systems
- collapse under ambiguity

Why it matters:

Emotional Physics is a **physics engine**.

AI is a **pattern engine**.

5. Field Echoes (Competitor Illusion)**Definition:**

The appearance of imitators, mimics, or adjacent practitioners when a new field is forming. These are not competitors — they are **echoes** produced by the gravitational pull of a forming trust center.

Why it matters:

Echoes signal that the field is warming and the trust center is gaining mass. They appear *before* a center move, not after.

6. Trust Center**Definition:**

The emotional and structural “center of gravity” in a system. The trust center determines how people orient, interpret signals, and make decisions.

Properties:

- every system has one
 - trust centers can move
 - trust centers determine field behavior
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7. Trust Center Move ($TC_1 \rightarrow TC_2$)**Definition:**

A shift in the system’s center of gravity from one domain to another — for example, from identity to utility, or from narrative to structure.

Why it matters:

A center move reorganizes the entire field.

It is the inflection point of growth.

8. ΔM (Mass Increase)

Definition:

The increase in trust-center mass caused by new clarity, new structure, or new value surfaces (e.g., glossary, workflow models, diagnostics).

Why it matters:

ΔM predicts when a trust center is about to move.

9. Drift

Definition:

The gap between what a system *says* it is and what it *actually* is. Drift is not moral or emotional — it is structural.

Why it matters:

Drift always precedes conflict.

It is the earliest warning signal in any system.

10. Drift Vector

Definition:

The direction and speed of drift in a system. Drift vectors show where a system is heading before it arrives.

Why it matters:

Drift vectors allow early intervention before collapse.

11. Pressure Gradient

Definition:

The difference in emotional or structural pressure across a system. Pressure reveals structure — it shows where the system is strong, weak, or misaligned.

Why it matters:

Pressure is diagnostic, not personal.

12. Identity Coherence

Definition:

The alignment between a system's stated identity and its actual behavior. High coherence = stability. Low coherence = drift.

Why it matters:

Identity coherence determines trust density.

13. Trust Density**Definition:**

The concentration of trust within a system. High trust density produces stability and flow. Low trust density produces turbulence and noise.

Why it matters:

Trust density is the real predictor of growth.

14. Field Reorganization (F_r)**Definition:**

The restructuring of a system after a trust center moves. People, roles, and behaviors reorganize around the new center.

Why it matters:

This is when teammates, collaborators, and early adopters appear.

15. Emotional Weather**Definition:**

The ambient emotional conditions in a system — pressure, clarity, turbulence, fog, warmth, coldness, etc.

Why it matters:

Emotional weather determines how people behave under load.

16. Signal

Definition:

The information a system emits through behavior, tone, timing, and action — not words. Signal is always more accurate than narrative.

Why it matters:

Signal reveals the true state of a system.

17. Field Conditions**Definition:**

The overall environment in which a system operates — trust, pressure, clarity, drift, identity, and emotional weather.

Why it matters:

Field conditions determine whether a system is laminar or turbulent.

18. System Altitude**Definition:**

The level at which a person interprets emotional and organizational information — interpersonal, structural, or systemic.

Why it matters:

Altitude determines clarity.

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